

January

24

41 CE

Emperor Claudius

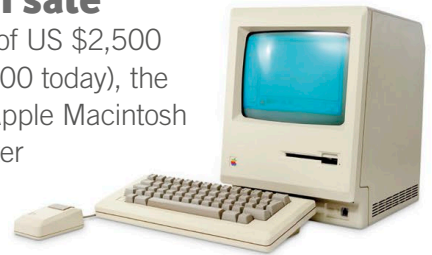
Disgusted at the tyranny of the Roman emperor Caligula, the imperial bodyguards assassinated him and proclaimed his uncle Claudius the new emperor. Claudius was an effective leader, and under his rule Rome finally conquered Britain.

Born this day

1864 Marguerite Durand, French women's rights activist. She founded a newspaper run exclusively by women and helped to create organizations for working women.

1984 Macintosh on sale

With a price tag of US \$2,500 (around US \$5,000 today), the first generation Apple Macintosh personal computer went on sale in the USA.



Also on this day

1859 Moldavia and Wallachia in central Europe were united by Alexandru Ioan Cuza. This region eventually became the country of Romania.

1986 Spacecraft *Voyager 2* came within 81,800 km (50,600 miles) of Uranus and discovered five new moons in its orbit.

2006 The Walt Disney Company took over Pixar, the pioneering computer animation studio behind *Toy Story*.

1848

California Gold Rush

Mill worker James W Marshall found flakes of gold at Sutter's Mill, along the Sacramento River in California, USA. Following his discovery, prospectors flocked to the area in search of gold.

